

## Benedict Guttman-Kenney: Teaching Statement\*

I have taught the core course in finance for the professional M.B.A. students at Rice University's Jones Graduate School of Business since 2025 ([syllabus](#)). I teach for twelve weeks of three-hour lectures to two sections of students in the first year of their M.B.A., with approximately fifty students in each section. A particular challenge of this class is that students have a wide range of backgrounds; some students work in finance, whereas other students have limited quantitative background and have never taken a finance course. In my first year of teaching, I broadly used the existing course structure. In my second year, I adapted the structure, including more cases and making the content more engaging. Based on course feedback, these changes have been a success.

Since 2026, I teach an elective course on FinTech for second-year Rice M.B.A. students ([syllabus](#)). I teach for six weeks of three-hour lectures. This FinTech course is a new course that I developed, which has not been previously offered by Rice. This course was challenging to design, as FinTech is constantly evolving and there are more topics than can be covered in six weeks. I made the course highly interactive with a combination of discussions of cases and topical FinTech issues. One week of the class was devoted to AI FinTech developments, and included the students vibe-coding on loan data. I love teaching this course, and look forward to continuing to do so.

I designed and taught an intensive introduction to microeconomics course for new cohorts of Chicago Booth behavioral science Ph.D. students. This was a challenging course to design, as students did not have math backgrounds. I needed to introduce them to the math notation used in economics papers and teach them about substantive economics. I customized the content of this class to the needs of the students to make the class useful for their Ph.D. careers.

I gave a lecture to 60 research professionals employed across departments of the University of Chicago on credit reporting data. I used this lecture as an opportunity to introduce the students not only to the topic, but also to teach the value as a researcher of gaining deep institutional knowledge in a topic or dataset that interests you.

I have lectured on my research as part of the Harris Lecture Series at the Indian School of Public Policy. My lectures were motivated by my research. The first on COVID-19 research led to my being invited back to lecture on Buy Now, Pay Later (BNPL). These lectures were both challenging and rewarding because I taught students with very different life experiences.

I was the only teaching assistant for all three sections of the inaugural Chicago Booth Consumer Finance M.B.A. course taught by Scott Nelson, and I also assisted with course design. For two years, I was a teaching assistant for two sections of Thomas Covert's Chicago Booth M.B.A. Competitive Strategy economics course.

While studying for my Ph.D., I completed my M.B.A. at Chicago Booth. This experience provides me with a greater understanding of the student experience and exposed me to a greater diversity of student backgrounds and teaching styles to learn from. Experiencing non-finance M.B.A. courses has especially helped me ensure that my M.B.A. finance courses are engaging.

Last Updated: July 29, 2026

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